



Shalom Zone Guide for Teens

Goal: To create a quiet/calm down space in your home for you to use to help regulate strong emotions in a healthy way.

Target Audience: Teens ages 13-18

Time: Approximately 1 hour to create or more if you want to be creative

Medium: @Home project

Note:

You are presented with tons of new experiences and expectations all the time. It can be hard to have a lot of expectations placed on you at school and not feel stressed at times. Life can sometimes feel overwhelming and it can be helpful to have a quiet place to unwind.

What is a Shalom Zone?

Sometimes winding down can be hard, especially with all of the distractions around like school, friends, parents, siblings, TV, internet, etc. Creating a quiet corner or a reading nook can give you a wonderful opportunity to find calm.

The Shalom Zone can be your safe space to go when you need help calming your body, taking a brain break, want to get a handle on your emotions, or just need some alone time. It is meant to be a place for you to relax, recharge, or even release your pent-up anger or frustration.

Picking The Right Space For The Shalom Zone

Talk to your parent and see if they have any ideas for where and how you could make a quiet space. Then work with your parent to try to pick one space in your house or apartment for your Shalom Zone area so that you can have one designated space. It should be away from distractions and can be really anywhere you want: in your bedroom, in the basement, under the stairs, in a closet, in a corner of a room — wherever you think you will be the most comfortable!

When To Use The Shalom Zone

The Shalom Zone space should feel welcoming and inviting to you. This is not a place for you to feel punished or isolated, rather a special place that you can feel safe to work out emotions, take a break and/or calm yourself down.

You can use the Shalom Zone right after school or before bed to help unwind and decompress after a long day. You can also use it when you feel frustrated, sad, angry, or any time your emotions feel intense.

What To Include In Your Shalom Zone

Do you have some comforting things that would make a calm space for you? If you are feeling really creative you can check out Pinterest or check out *Quiet Spaces* online for ideas that use things around the house to make a cool area. You can also visit a thrift store, Dollar Store, or Amazon if you want to decorate your space.

It can also be helpful to consider having a poster with reminders on how you like to calm down, calming stretches or exercises, motivational phrases or pictures, or different emotions you may be feeling. This is not a space to be on your phone with friends, or play video games - as tempting as it may be. This is a space to take time to reduce distractions and sensory input and focus on those that can calm you outside of technology.

- Here are some examples of items to consider including in your Shalom Zone: ● Printable Signs to Hang:
 - ○ A [“My Shalom Zone”](#) sign that your child designs and can hang in their space
 - ○ Emotional Regulation Chart - [What Zone Am I In?](#)
 - ○ [10 Steps to Calm Down](#)
 - ○ [“Shalom Zone” Exercises](#)
 - ○ [“Shalom Zone” Motivational Phrases](#)
 - ○ [“Shalom Zone” Emotions](#)
- A comfy place to sit like a bean bag chair, some pillows, or big chair
- A journal to document your journey or get out your emotions
- A sketchbook to express your feelings or relax through art
- Lego, playdough/clay, or some fun toy that you may still like to play with
- [Fidget toys to spin, twist and manipulate](#)
- Art supplies and/or sticker books
- [Weighted Blanket](#)
- Puzzles
- [One Person card games](#)
- Noise-reducing headphones to block out sounds that are overwhelming
- [Chewy jewelry and toys](#)
- Stress balls to squeeze or [make your own!](#)
- A favorite stuffed animal to hug
- [Something visual like a sensory bottle, kaleidoscope or lava lamp](#) or [make your own!](#)
- Engaging one-person activities like activity books, individual board games, building blocks, drawing books or magnet tiles.